

Reading into Writing

Feedback for Week 3



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Understanding the question



This week the question was:

How should governments react to the shift towards low fertility and population aging described by Sciuba as, “the most fundamental shift to take place in modern history”?

- How easy/difficult did you find the question?
- This was more a ‘problem-solution’ question than a ‘debate’ question.
 - What are the two problems?
 - What are some of the solutions?

Structure



- How did you structure your answer?
- Write your essay structure on a piece of paper (or on your computer) e.g.
 - Introduction
 - P1 =
 - P2 =
 - P3 =
 - Conclusion

- Ask a classmate to read your introduction and see if they can guess the structure of your essay correctly.
- Now ask a different classmate to read your conclusion and see if they can guess the structure of your essay correctly.
- Finally, ask a third classmate to read your topic sentences and see if they can tell you what the structure of your essay was.

Citations



- Ezeh, A. C., Bongaarts, J., & Mberu, B. (2012). Global population trends and policy options. *The Lancet*, 380(9837), 142-148.
- (Ezeh et al, 2012)
- Bloom, D. E., Canning, D., & Lubet, A. (2015). Global population aging: Facts, challenges, solutions & perspectives. *Daedalus*, 144(2), 80-92.
- (Bloom et al, 2015)
- Jones, G. W. (2019). Ultra-low fertility in East Asia: Policy responses and challenges. *Asian Population Studies*, 15(2), 131-149..
- (Jones, 2019)

Questions to consider:



- Did you cite all three of the extracts?
- How many citations does your essay contain in total?
- Do you have any paragraphs without any citations (except for the introduction and conclusion)?
- How many of your paragraphs have citations to more than one extract?
- How similar/different did you think the extracts were?

Using the extracts: increasing fertility



	Ezeh et al (2012)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
Policies for increasing fertility	• Birth bonuses • Family support measures like subsidised childcare • Reduced taxes for families with children • Paid parental leave • Dating services	None	• Support for childcare • Increased parental leave • Options to enhance work-life balance • Monthly child allowances
Comments on efficacy	• Fertility is less than desired family size so these policies should be effective • However, to date the effect has been modest in countries like Japan, Italy & Spain	None	• Evidence suggests these policies have had little impact in countries like Singapore

Using the extracts: increasing fertility continued



	Jones (2019)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
Policies for increasing fertility	You can't (shouldn't list all of these policies. To make them more manageable, you could try to categorise them.		• Pressure employers to modify the work culture • Provide greater financial support and stability for parents • Help women combine raising a family and having a career (requires changing men's attitudes) • Modify the pressure on parents to raise 'successful' children
Comments on efficacy			• If all these policies are implemented, it may change the 'rational decision by many women to opt out of marriage and childbearing'.

For example:



	Ezeh et al (2012)	Jones (2019)
Money	• Birth bonuses • Family support measures like subsidised childcare • Reduced taxes for families with children • Paid parental leave	• Support for childcare • Monthly child allowances • Greater financial support and stability for parents
Work		• Increased parental leave • Options to enhance work-life balance • Pressure on employers to modify the work culture
Society	• Dating services	• Help women combine raising a family and having a career (requires changing men's attitudes) • Modify the pressure on parents to raise 'successful' children

For example:

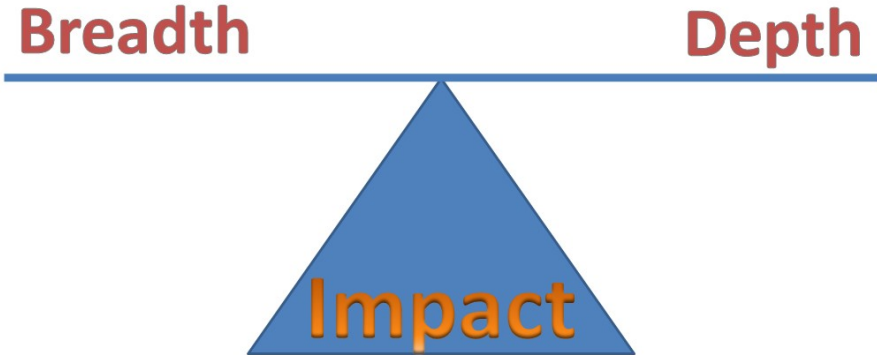


	Ezeh et al (2012)	Jones (2019)
Money	• Birth bonuses • Family support measures like subsidised childcare • Reduced taxes for families with children • Paid parental leave	• Support for childcare • Monthly child allowances • Greater financial support and stability for parents
Work	Note: some policies could fit into more than one category. For example, 'paid parental leave' could be categorised as 'money', 'work' or 'society'.	• Increased parental leave • Options to enhance work-life balance • Pressure on employers to modify the work culture
Society		• Help women combine raising a family and having a career (requires changing men's attitudes) • Modify the pressure on parents to raise 'successful' children

For example:



	Ezeh et al (2012)	Jones (2019)
Money	• Birth bonuses • Family support measures like subsidised childcare • Reduced taxes for families with children • Paid parental leave	• Support for childcare • Monthly child allowances • Even if you are able to simplify the list of policies by putting them into categories, you'll still need to be selective about which policies you mention. You have to balance breadth & depth.
Work	Note: some policies could fit into more than one category. For example, 'paid parental leave' could be categorised as 'money', 'work' or 'society'.	• • •
Society	•	• • •



Put it together: increasing fertility



When discussing policies to increase fertility, you should comment on their efficacy. The extracts make some suggestions (green = positive; red = negative)

	Ezeh et al (2012)	Jones (2019)
Comments on efficacy	• Fertility is less than desired family size so these policies should be effective • However, to date the effect has been modest in countries like Japan, Italy & Spain	• Evidence suggests these policies have had little impact in countries like Singapore • If multiple policies are implemented, it may change the 'rational decision by many women to opt out of marriage and childbearing'.

Using the extracts: managing aging populations



	Ezeh et al (2012)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
Policies to counter aging populations	• Immigration	• Increased rates of savings • Increased labour supply from women, older people and migrants • Policies that allow for healthy living • Need to change policies & behaviour	• Immigration
Comments on efficacy	• Very large numbers will be needed (hundreds of millions) • May lead to 'brain drain' in the countries of origin	• May lessen the economic burden • May improve the well-being of older people • May recognise older people as a resource, not a burden • May increase longevity	• Need large amounts of immigration to make a real difference • Not popular

All the extracts mention immigration as a strategy (including its downsides)

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Policies to counter aging	Immigration	- Increased rates of savings - Increased labour supply from women, older people and migrants - Policies that allow for healthy living - Need to change policies & behaviour	Immigration
Comments on efficacy	- Very large numbers will be needed (hundreds of millions) - May lead to 'brain drain' in the countries of origin	- May lessen the economic burden - May improve the well-being of older people - May recognise older people as a resource, not a burden - May increase longevity	- Need large amounts of immigration to make a real difference - Not popular

Again, you'll have to be selective about which policies you choose to include in your essay.

Examples:

- Why are examples useful in academic writing?
- Look at language for examples in the Academic Phrasebank and choose 5 phrases you like: [Academic Phrasebank](#)
- Compare the phrases you chose with a partner



This is what the Academic Phrasebank says about using examples...



Writers may give specific examples as evidence to support their general claims or arguments. Examples can also be used to help the reader or listener understand unfamiliar or difficult concepts, and they tend to be easier to remember. For this reason, they are often used in teaching.

Finally, students may be required to give examples in their work to demonstrate that they have understood a complex problem or concept. It is important to note that when statements are supported with examples, the explicit language signalling this may not always be used.

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Examples:



How many countries or regions were listed in the extracts?

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Ezeh et al (2012)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
1. Europe 2. USA 3. Canada 4. Africa / sub-Saharan Africa 5. Asia / southeast Asia 6. Latin America 7. Japan 8. Italy 9. Spain	1. United States	1. China 2. South Korea 3. Japan 4. Singapore 5. East Asia

Examples:



What, if anything, does this tell you about the focus of the extracts?

Ezeh et al (2012)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
1. Europe 2. USA 3. Canada 4. Africa / sub-Saharan Africa 5. Asia / southeast Asia 6. Latin America 7. Japan 8. Italy 9. Spain	1. United States	1. China 2. South Korea 3. Japan 4. Singapore 5. East Asia

Examples:

What were the countries listed as examples of?

Ezeh et al (2012)	Bloom et al (2015)	Jones (2019)
1. Europe 2. USA 3. Canada 4. Africa / sub-Saharan Africa 5. Asia / southeast Asia 6. Latin America 7. Japan 8. Italy 9. Spain	1. United States	1. China 2. South Korea 3. Japan 4. Singapore 5. East Asia

Examples:



Did you give examples of any countries in your essay? If so, which ones and why?

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1. Europe 2. USA 3. Canada 4. Africa / sub-Saharan Africa 5. Asia / southeast Asia 6. Latin America 7. Japan 8. Italy 9. Spain	1. United States	1. China 2. South Korea 3. Japan 4. Singapore 5. East Asia

Words:

What is the difference between:

- immigration, emigration and migration (or immigrants, emigrants and migrants)?
- older, oldest, elder, eldest and elderly?



Reading into Writing AI Feedback Workbook



Use your workbook for some additional feedback.



Once you have completed the workbook,
discuss:



1. Did you find the feedback useful?
2. What, if anything, have you learned?
3. Was there anything that surprised you?

